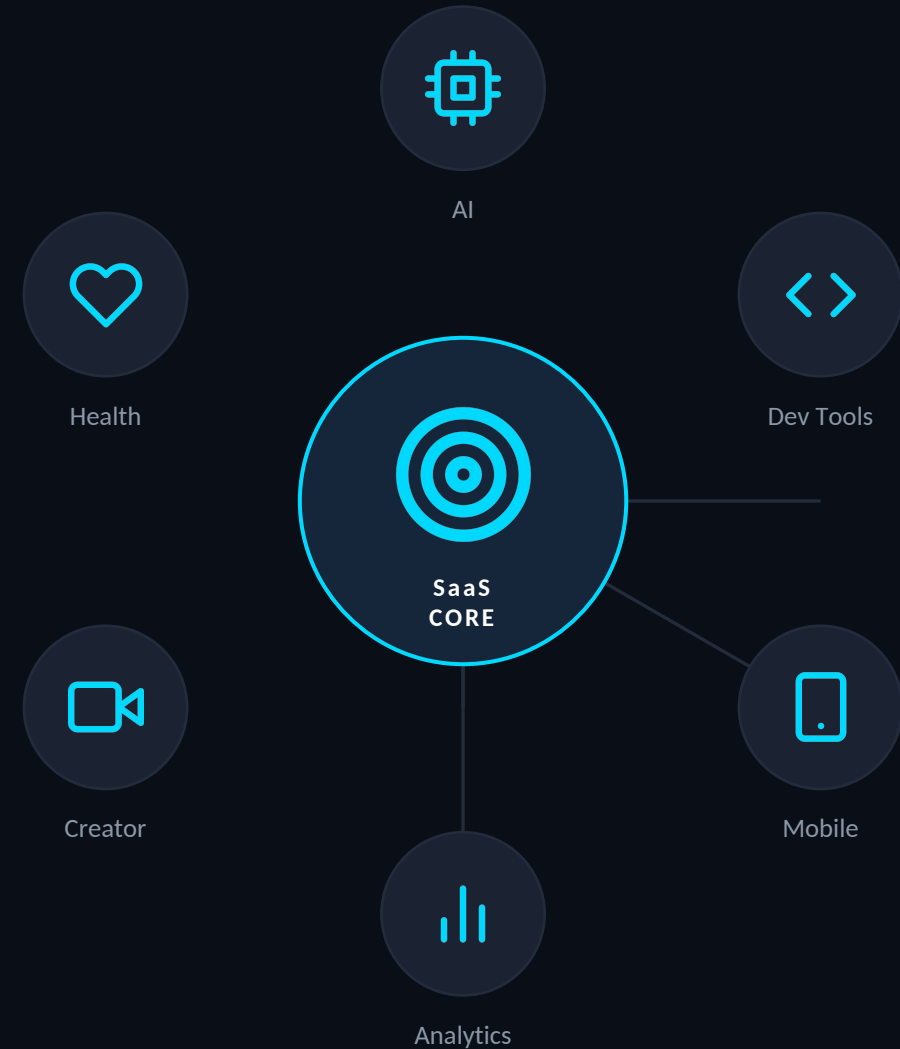


The Startup Landscape

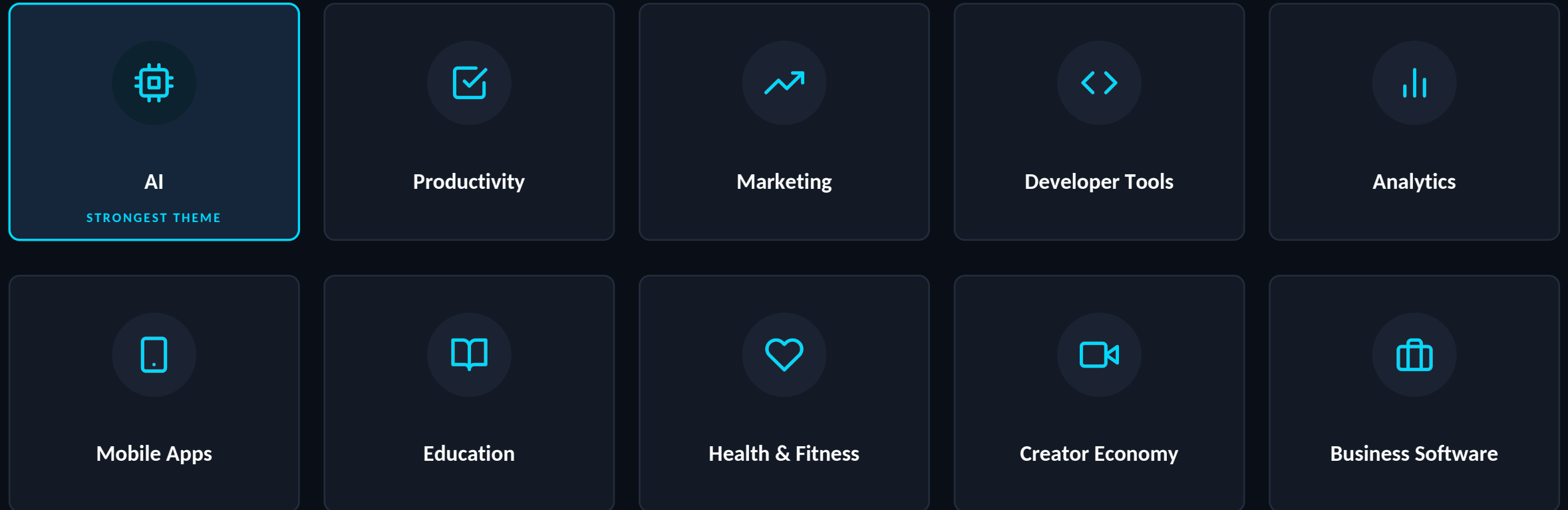
A digital-first, subscription-powered software economy — built for recurring revenue, not one-time sales.

- Digital-first, subscription-based businesses
- AI is the strongest cross-cutting theme
- SaaS is the dominant business model



Where Founders Are Building

Startups span ten active sectors and typically operate across multiple markets rather than one niche.



Business Models Driving Growth

SaaS anchors a digital-first, subscription-based economy — software delivered and billed continuously, not sold once.

Digital-first software businesses

The foundation of the ecosystem

Subscription-based delivery

Continuous value, continuous billing

SaaS — the dominant business model

The category founders converge on

Digital-first

Products built and sold entirely online, with no physical delivery layer.

Subscription-based

Revenue accrues continuously through active subscriber relationships.

SaaS-dominant

The prevailing packaging for functionality, pricing, and delivery alike.

Customer Demand & Market Focus



B2C

Dominant segment across the ecosystem



B2B

A significant, established segment

WHO THEY SERVE



Professionals



Creators



Developers



Founders



Students



SMBs

CORE PROBLEMS SOLVED



Productivity



Workflow



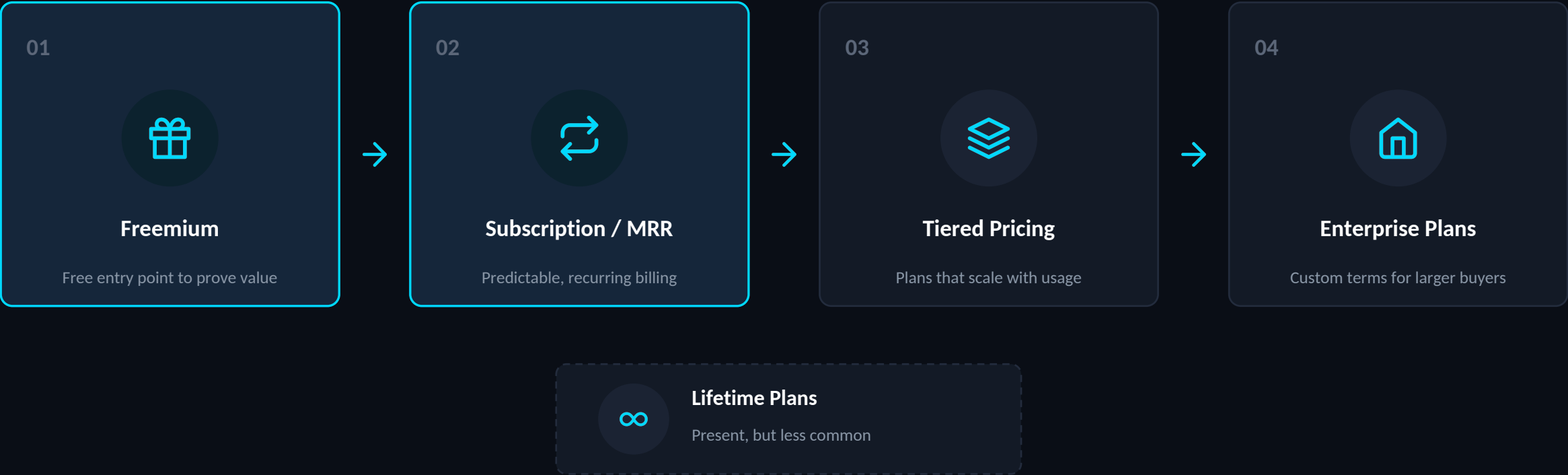
Automation



Content Creation

Monetization Strategies

Recurring, tiered monetization dominates the ecosystem — lifetime plans exist but remain the exception.

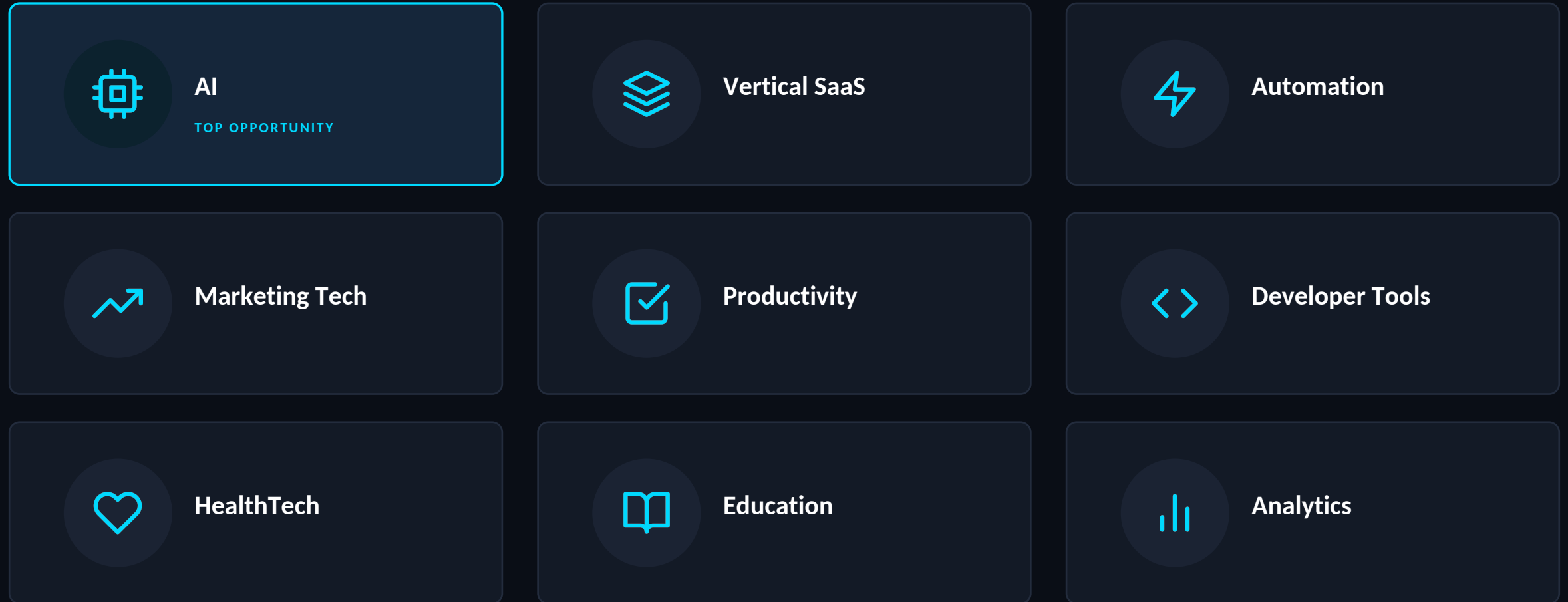


Characteristics of High-Quality Startups



Emerging Investment Opportunities

Nine areas represent the strongest opportunities for investors entering the ecosystem.



Investor Takeaways

01

A recurring-revenue economy

Subscription, MRR, freemium, and tiered pricing define how value is captured.

02

AI is the connective thread

It runs across sectors rather than sitting in a single vertical.

03

Founders build broad, not narrow

Multi-market products are the norm, expanding addressable demand.

04

Retention signals quality

Recurring revenue, retention, and scalability are the clearest quality markers.

INFRASTRUCTURE BACKBONE



Stripe

Dominant payment infrastructure across the ecosystem



RevenueCat

Widely used for subscription-based mobile apps

TrustMRR reflects a modern software economy built for scalable, recurring revenue — not one-time sales.